

Consent form

You are being asked to participate in a voluntary research study. Participating in this study will involve (1) reading a brief introduction and informed consent; (2) completing a survey where you will watch videos of different websites' loading processes. Your participation will last about 15 minutes.

Risks and Benefits

There are no risks beyond those in everyday life related to participating in this research. However, if you don't feel comfortable looking at videos of commonplace web pages rendering, you should not participate.

What procedures are involved?

The study will be conducted via an online survey. You will watch videos showing website loading processes. At the end of the survey, we will ask for your demographic information (including education level and computer knowledge). This research will be performed online at Prolific. You can only participate once. Each survey will last about 15 minutes.

Will my study-related information be kept confidential?

We can only access the information you provide in this survey and have no access to any additional data you provided to Prolific (e.g., information submitted during registration). All data collected in this survey is anonymous, and we do not collect any personally identifiable information.

Will I be reimbursed for any expenses or paid for my participation in this research?

Each participant will receive about \$2.75 to compensate their time to investigate in the study. You will receive the full payment after you watch the videos, complete and return the questionnaire. Otherwise, no payment will be made. If you decide to withdraw your data after returning the questionnaire, we will remove your response. In that case, you can still keep the full payment given your time invested into the study.

Can I withdraw or be removed from the study?

If you decide to participate, you are free to withdraw your consent and discontinue participation at any time. Your participation in this research is voluntary.

Will data collected from me be used for any other research?

Your de-identified information could be used for future research without additional informed consent.

Who should I contact if I have questions?

Contact XXX if you have any questions about this study or your part in it, or if you have concerns or complaints about the research.

I have read and understood the consent form above. I confirm that I am 18 years or older. By clicking the "I AGREE" button to enter the survey, I indicate my willingness to voluntarily take part in this study.

- ☐ I AGREE, I wish to take part in this study.
- ☐ I DISAGREE, I do not wish to take part in this study.



Does the video play smoothly on your current network connection?

- ☐ **Yes**, The video played smoothly with no noticeable buffering.
- ☐ **No**, The video did not play smoothly; I experienced buffering or stalls.



Powered by Qualtrics 

Survey Procedure

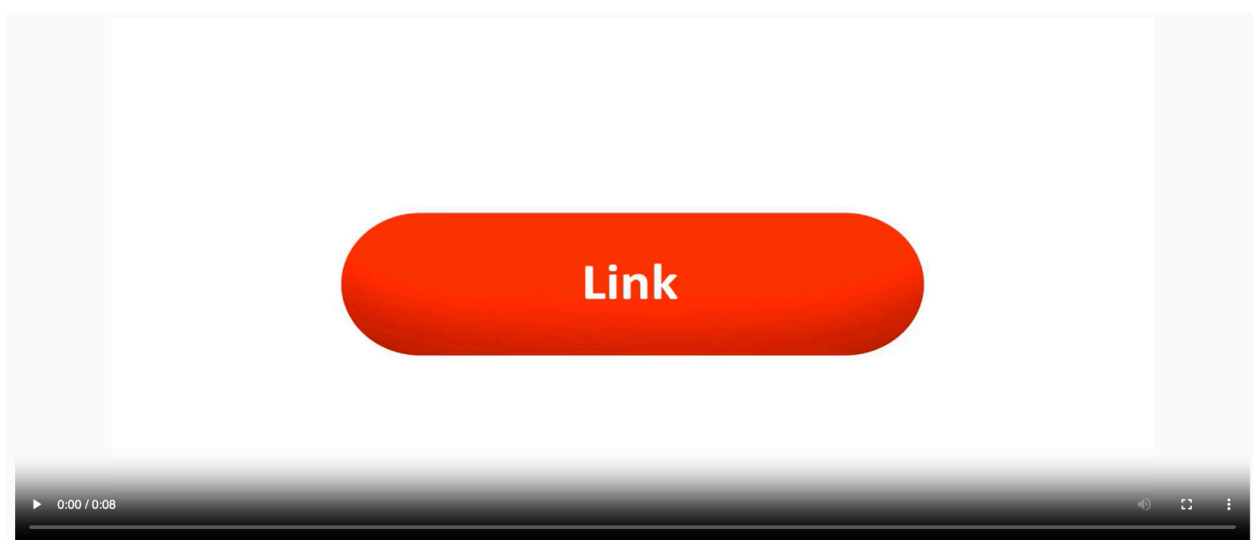
This survey consists of two parts, both involving videos of a website loading; the website always represents a well-known brand. In Part 1, you will watch five pairs of videos and evaluate **how similar** the videos in each pair are. Instructions for Part 2 will be provided at the beginning of that section. Regardless, for both parts, you will be asked to specify the brand shown in the video and express your familiarity with such a brand.

Please note: Once you move forward in this survey, you cannot return to previous pages. We kindly ask that you watch each video at least once before answering the questions. If the videos are not watched, the survey will not be eligible for compensation. Thank you for your time and participation!

Part 1

Part 1: You will be asked to watch 5 pairs of videos and rate the similarity of each pair.

VIDEO 1:



VIDEO 2:



How would you rate the similarity of the website's loading process shown in these two videos (from 1 to 4, 1 is "not similar" and 4 is "identical")?

1 (Not Similar)	2 (Somewhat Similar)	3 (Similar)	4 (Identical)
☐	☐	☐	☐

What is the name of the brand captured in the video? (If you cannot recognize the brand, write "Don't know")

How familiar are you with this brand?

☐ I am not familiar with it at all.
☐ I know the brand, but I do not visit its website often.
☐ I know the brand well, and visit the websites of this brand very often.

This is the 1/5 pair.

Part 2

You are now moving on to **Part 2**. In this part, you will watch 25 videos showing the loading processes of 5 different websites, with five videos for each website. For each video, you will be asked to indicate **how much you trust** the webpage based on the loading process shown. You will also be asked to provide the **name of the brand of the webpage** shown in each set of 5 videos, and indicate your familiarity with such a brand.

Phishing websites steal sensitive information such as login credentials, financial information, or personal information. Some malicious 'phishing' websites may try to tamper with the loading process to evade detection of existing mechanisms. Please note that even legitimate websites may not load instantly. So, we want to know, based on what you see on the video, if you would consider the corresponding webpage as trustworthy.

Part 2: You will be asked to evaluate videos of five websites, with five videos per website, and to indicate the trustworthiness of each video.

VIDEO 1:



The video player displays a red button with the text "Link" in white. The video progress bar at the bottom shows 0:00 / 0:08. Below the video player, there is a question and four radio button options for trust evaluation.

If you were visiting the webpage of this well-known website, how much would you trust such a webpage if its rendering process resembled that shown in the video (from 1 to 4, 1 is "Distrust" and 4 is "Trust")?

1 (Distrust)	2 (Somewhat Distrust)	3 (Somewhat Trust)	4 (Trust)
☐	☐	☐	☐

VIDEO 2:



If you were visiting the webpage of this well-known website, how much would you trust such a webpage if its rendering process resembled that shown in the video (from 1 to 4, 1 is "Distrust" and 4 is "Trust")?

1 (Distrust)	2 (Somewhat Distrust)	3 (Somewhat Trust)	4 (Trust)
☐	☐	☐	☐

VIDEO 3:



If you were visiting the webpage of this well-known website, how much would you trust such a webpage if its rendering process resembled that shown in the video (from 1 to 4, 1 is "Distrust" and 4 is "Trust")?

1 (Distrust)	2 (Somewhat Distrust)	3 (Somewhat Trust)	4 (Trust)
☐	☐	☐	☐

VIDEO 4:



If you were visiting the webpage of this well-known website, how much would you trust such a webpage if its rendering process resembled that shown in the video (from 1 to 4, 1 is "Distrust" and 4 is "Trust")?

1 (Distrust)	2 (Somewhat Distrust)	3 (Somewhat Trust)	4 (Trust)
☐	☐	☐	☐

VIDEO 5:



If you were visiting the webpage of this well-known website, how much would you trust such a webpage if its rendering process resembled that shown in the video (from 1 to 4, 1 is "Distrust" and 4 is "Trust")?

1 (Distrust)	2 (Somewhat Distrust)	3 (Somewhat Trust)	4 (Trust)
☐	☐	☐	☐

What is the name of the brand captured in the video? (If you cannot recognize the brand, write "Don't know")

How familiar are you with this brand?

☐ I am not familiar with it at all.

☐ I know the brand, but I do not visit its website often.

☐ I know the brand well, and visit the websites of this brand very often.

This is the 1 / 5 website.



Demographic:

What is the highest level of education you have completed?

☐ Some high school or less

☐ High school diploma or GED

☐ Some college, but no degree

☐ Associates or technical degree

☐ Bachelor's degree

☐ Graduate or professional degree (MA, MS, MBA, PhD, JD, MD, DDS etc.)

☐ Prefer not to say

What is your gender?

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Non-binary / Other gender

☐ Prefer not to say

How old are you?

☐ 18-29

☐ 30-39

☐ 40-49

☐ 50-59

☐ 60-69

☐ 70 or above

☐ Prefer not to say

Do you have a technical background in computer science or computer engineering?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Prefer not to say

Do you have a technical background in cyber security?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Prefer not to say